AFTER MORE THAN 26 years at Capgemini, Jayanthi stepped away from a full-time executive role in March 2026. She led the company's business in Canada and Latin America, served as CEO of Capgemini India and CEO of Business Services, and headed its Asia-Pacific and Latin America operations. She was also a member of the Group Executive Committee and part of the core team that established Capgemini's offshore capabilities.

Her career has not ended with her executive role. She is now a member of the supervisory board of Michelin Group and a board member of Barry Callebaut. Her governance experience also includes chairing the Board of Governors of the National Institute of Technology Calicut, serving as an independent director at SBI Capital Markets, and being part of Nasscom's Executive Council.

Yet planning for life after a full-time leadership role did not receive enough attention while she was still in one.

"I suppose the assumption is that C-suite executives are experienced enough to know what they want to do next and will plan for it! But often, one is so caught up in the full-time demands of the job, that planning for the next chapter doesn't get enough attention and for sure, I didn't do enough of it," she says.

Jayanthi is focusing on three areas: continuing her corporate board work, helping startups and entrepreneurs scale, and advising a social enterprise developing women-led initiatives in rural India.

However, she cautions against succumbing to social pressure and the inevitable questions about what comes next. The first challenge, she says, is often a lack of clarity.

Jayanthi believes organisations must also rethink how they engage senior talent. Most were designed around full-time employees working together in the same physical location. Remote work has loosened that model, but employment structures have not changed enough to accommodate people who want to contribute without returning to conventional full-time roles.

She now has more time to learn, speak to people in different fields and understand developments in management, technology, community development and innovation.

"The big difference now is that I have more time to learn," she says.



"Pursue the Right Opportunities, Not Just Opportunities"

ARUNA JAYANTHI
Former Capgemini executive and a member of the supervisory board of Michelin Group